

Cluster 5: Health and Sports

This cluster joins a sports-governance backgrounder with a public-health backgrounder. Together they cover youth development, fitness, disease control and the ethics of state responsibility.

Current Affair: The Making of a Sporting Nation

Date: 2026-07-27 | **Theme:** Sports ecosystem | **Subject:** Sports / Youth development | **GS Mapping:** GS2 / GS1 / Essay | **Priority:** Medium | **Suggested Depth:** Standard

Sources:

PIB backgrounder: <https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2289962>(=1@=48

Fact snapshot

- India's first CWG appearance was in 1934.
- The backgrounder frames Khelo India as a route from playgrounds to podiums.
- Use this for sports governance and youth development answers.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Legacy	India's Commonwealth Games journey began in 1934; 2026 is the 19th appearance.	PIB	■	Prelims
Scheme	Khelo India is the central sports development framework.	PIB	■	Mains
Goal	Create a pathway from playgrounds to Olympic podiums.	PIB	■	Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail	Source	Confidence
Immediate trigger	Backgrounder released as CWG returned to Glasgow.	PIB, 27 Jul 2026	■
Historical origin	Khelo India emerged as the sports-sector transformation mission.	Policy background	■
UPSC relevance	Sports policy, youth development and social inclusion.	Syllabus	■

Historical Timeline

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters	Source	Confidence
1934	India's first Commonwealth Games appearance	Long sporting history	PIB	■
2026	19th CWG appearance	Current milestone	PIB	■

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage	Source / Basis	Confidence
Sports policy	Grassroots-to-elite development pipeline	GS2	Syllabus	■
Youth	Fitness, discipline and national identity	GS1 / GS2	Syllabus	■

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Khelo India Scheme	Sports mission	Central policy tool	PIB	■	Mains
Fit India Movement	Health and fitness push	Lifestyle dimension	PIB	■	Mains

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning	Domain	Source	Confidence
CWG	Commonwealth Games	International multi-sport event	Sports	PIB	■
KIA	Khelo India Athletes	Supported athlete cohort	Sports	PIB	■

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Source / Basis	Exam Use
Scope	Thinking sports policy is only about medals	The release focuses on ecosystem, fitness and inclusion too.	PIB	Mains
Legacy	Treating CWG history as incidental	It is a timeline anchor.	PIB	Prelims

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition	Source / Basis
Youth development	Sports as a tool for capability and discipline	GS2 / GS1	Fitness and inclusion	PIB
International prestige	How sporting success shapes national image	Essay	CWG legacy	PIB

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Source / Basis	Priority
Static syllabus link	Sports policy, youth development, fitness	Medium	Syllabus	Medium
Official source link	PIB sporting nation backgrounder	High	PIB	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Ethics / Virtue Ethics	Arete / excellence	Sport trains excellence through habit, discipline and self-mastery	Use the sporting nation as an example of character-building	GS1 / Essay / Optional	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching

- Virtue ethics focuses on character and habits, not only rules or outcomes.
- Sports is a natural example because it rewards discipline, courage and excellence.
- Use the release to connect excellence in sport with excellence in civic life.
- Possible answer line: 'A sporting culture cultivates virtues that are valuable far beyond the field.'
- Caution: keep the analogy simple and readable.

Inference

- This is a good bridge between sports and youth policy.

- The timeline of India at the CWG is the easiest factual hook.

UPSC Synthesis

- Why UPSC cares: sports policy has moved from event coverage to ecosystem design.
- Static linkage: Khelo India, FIT India, youth development, elite pathways.
- Philosophy linkage: virtue ethics and excellence.

Revision Notes

- India's first CWG appearance was in 1934.
- The backgrounder frames Khelo India as a route from playgrounds to podiums.
- Use this for sports governance and youth development answers.

Current Affair: India's Fight to Combat Hepatitis

Date: 2026-07-27 | **Theme:** Public health | **Subject:** Health / Governance | **GS Mapping:** GS2 / GS3 | **Priority:** Medium | **Suggested Depth:** Standard

Sources:

PIB backgrounder: <https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2289761>

Fact snapshot

- India aims to combat hepatitis by 2030.
- NVHCP is the key programme under NHM.
- Free drugs and diagnostics are part of the policy architecture.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Goal	India aims to combat hepatitis by 2030.	PIB	■	Mains
Programme	National Viral Hepatitis Control Programme uses a health-systems approach.	PIB	■	Mains
Services	Free drugs and diagnostics are included for affected people.	PIB	■	Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail	Source	Confidence
Immediate trigger	Backgrounder on hepatitis was released on 27 July 2026.	PIB	■
Historical origin	NVHCP was launched in 2018 under NHM.	PIB / health ministry	■
UPSC relevance	Disease control, public health systems and SDG 3.3.	Syllabus	■

Historical Timeline

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters	Source	Confidence
2018	NVHCP launched	Programme origin	PIB / MoHFW	■
2030 target	End hepatitis as a public health threat	Policy goal	WHO / PIB	■

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage	Source / Basis	Confidence
Public health	Prevention, diagnosis, treatment and surveillance	GS2 / GS3	Syllabus	■
SDGs	SDG 3.3 and health systems strengthening	GS2	Syllabus	■

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
NVHCP	National programme	Core institutional response	PIB	■	Mains
NHM	National Health Mission	Programme umbrella	PIB / MoHFW	■	Mains

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning	Domain	Source	Confidence
NVHCP	National Viral Hepatitis Control Programme	India's hepatitis control programme	Health	PIB	■
NHM	National Health Mission	Programme umbrella	Health	PIB	■
SDG	Sustainable Development Goal	UN framework	Health	WHO / UN	■

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Source / Basis	Exam Use
Disease type	Confusing hepatitis with a single virus	It includes A, B, C, D and E strains.	WHO / PIB	Prelims
Programme scope	Thinking treatment alone is enough	Prevention, diagnostics and systems strengthening are part of it.	PIB	Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition	Source / Basis
Public health systems	Why disease control requires diagnostics and access	GS2 / GS3	Health system approach	PIB
Ethics	Equity in access to free treatment and diagnostics	GS4 / GS2	Health justice	Synthesis

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Source / Basis	Priority
Static syllabus link	Public health, communicable disease control	High	Syllabus	High
Official source link	PIB hepatitis backgrounder	High	PIB	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Applied Philosophy / Bioethics	Public health ethics	Health policy must balance prevention, access and equity	Use hepatitis control as an example of health justice	GS2 / GS4 / Optional	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching

- Public health ethics asks how society should protect vulnerable people fairly.
- Free diagnostics and drugs are practical expressions of health justice.
- Use the release to show that disease control is both medical and moral.
- Possible answer line: 'A fair health system reduces suffering by combining prevention, access and dignity.'
- Caution: stay focused on the policy example rather than over-philosophising the disease itself.

Inference

- The key exam word is health-systems approach.
- Remember the 2030 elimination framing and the NVHCP acronym.

UPSC Synthesis

- Why UPSC cares: public health questions often test programmes and disease-control frameworks.
- Static linkage: communicable diseases, NHM, SDG 3.3.
- Philosophy linkage: public health ethics and justice.

Revision Notes

- India aims to combat hepatitis by 2030.
- NVHCP is the key programme under NHM.
- Free drugs and diagnostics are part of the policy architecture.

Cluster Self-Test

- The sports backgrounder uses which central scheme?

- Khelo India
- PM-KISAN
- NVHCP
- PM-SSY

Answer: Khelo India

Why: It is the core sports mission.

- The hepatitis release is linked to which programme?

- National Viral Hepatitis Control Programme
- Khelo Bharat Niti
- PM-VBRY
- NITI Aayog fellowship

Answer: National Viral Hepatitis Control Programme

Why: That programme was explicitly named.

- What is the key philosophy lens for sports?

- Virtue ethics
- Fatalism
- Solipsism
- Nominalism

Answer: Virtue ethics

Why: Sport develops discipline and excellence.

- Which static concept matters most for hepatitis?

- Public health systems and disease control
- Only foreign policy
- Only labour markets
- Only urban planning

Answer: Public health systems and disease control

Why: That is the syllabus fit.

- Hepatitis control most directly raises which ethical concern?

- Health justice and access
- Tax evasion
- Monarchy
- Merit lists

Answer: Health justice and access

Why: The release emphasises free drugs and diagnostics.

Topic Readiness / Worthiness

Topic	Worthiness Score	One-line reason
The Making of a Sporting Nation	8.1/10	Good sports and youth policy bridge.
India's Fight to Combat Hepatitis	8.6/10	Strong health systems and ethics value.